

Development of Education in Modern India

1. Consider the following statements regarding Wood's Dispatch of 1854 :

1. It recommended English as the medium of instruction for higher studies.
2. It laid stress on female education and vocational training.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Wood's Dispatch was issued on 19 July, 1854 with Sir Charles Wood as the President of the Board of Control. It recommended English as the medium of instruction for higher studies and also emphasised the government should support education for women.

2. In which year Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh was established?

- (a) 1870 (b) 1880
(c) 1890 (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (e)

In 1877, Sir Syed Founded the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College in Aligarh and patterned the college after Oxford and Cambridge University which he had visited on a trip to England. It was one of the first purely residential educational institutions set up either by the government or the public in India. By 1920, the college was transformed into the Aligarh Muslim University.

3. When was the National Council of Education established?

- (a) 15th August, 1903 (b) 15th August, 1904
(c) 15th August, 1905 (d) 15th August, 1906

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

The citizens of Rangpur held a conference on 16 November, 1905. In 1905, the Rangpur National School was started with the objective of imparting indigenous education both general and technical to Indians. The birth of the National school sparked off the movement culminating in the formation of the National Council of Education (NCE) Bengal on 15th August, 1906.

4. When did the British Government appoint Sadler University Commission for reforms in education :

- (a) 1919 (b) 1917
(c) 1921 (d) 1896

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Sadler Commission (Calcutta University Commission) was related to education. In 1917, the Government of India appointed a commission to study and report on the problems of Calcutta University. Dr. M.E. Sadler, Vice-Chancellor of the University of Leeds, was appointed its Chairman. The commission included two Indian members, namely Sir Ashutosh Mukherjee and Dr. Zia-ud-din Ahmad. The Sadler Commission held the view that the improvement of secondary education was a necessary condition for the improvement of University education. It strongly criticized the University Act, 1904 and reported that there is no proper coordination between colleges and universities.

5. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

- (a) Raja Rammohan Roy was the pioneer of modern education.
(b) Swami Dayanand proclaimed India for Indians.
(c) Vivekananda participated in the Parliament of World Religions.
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (d)

Raja Rammohan Roy made outstanding contributions to India's educational system. Many English-language schools were established by him to reform the educational system. Arya Samaj movement for instilling pride of their religion and self confidence in themselves, paved way for the rise of a national movement against the British rule in India. Mrs. Annie Besant of the Theosophical Society said, "It was Dayanand Saraswati who first proclaimed that India was for the Indians". Swami Vivekananda is best known in the United States for his groundbreaking speech to the 1893 World's Parliament of Religions in which he introduced Hinduism to America and called for religious tolerance and an end to fanaticism. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

6. Which of the following Indians qualified Indian Civil Service Exam for the first time in 1863?

- (a) Debendranath Thakur
(b) Satyendranath Thakur
(c) Surendranath Banerjee